



Discussion Guide: Yolanda Pierce

Salvation and Soul Food

Reflect

- When you hear the term “theologian” what sort of people come to mind? What do they all share in common?
- Pierce asks us to consider people like her grandmother and the women on her church’s “mother’s board” as great theologians. How would seeing these women as theologians change the way you think about what is required to be a theologian? How does it change your view of what theology is?
- Pierce explains that soul food emerged out of the scraps and bits of food that were given to enslaved people. In your view, how is this an apt metaphor for the work of creation that God does in the world? In your own life?

Respond

- What unconventional sources of theological wisdom have you drawn on in your life? How do they shape your life and faith?
- Name an individual in the Bible who, like Pierce’s grandmother, embodies “theology in action” despite not being formally recognized by the religious authorities. What do you admire about them?
- Who in your own church or community tends to be overlooked as a source of theology? Why? What might your church or community learn by taking their insights and questions seriously?